

Session I: Ancient Egypt — Due October 5

1. Read Ancient Egypt: The Cosmos, Pharaohs, and Egyptian Gods
2. Do the homework for What Bible Stories Include Egypt?
3. Have fun with optional extension activities from Mummification and Medicine.

Ancient Egypt: The Cosmos, Pharaohs, and Egyptian Gods

Ancient Egyptians didn't just study the stars for curiosity — they believed the sky itself was filled with gods, and their entire understanding of the world grew out of that belief. Egyptians worshipped many different deities, each responsible for a different part of life: Ra ruled as the supreme sun god, Hapi controlled the Nile's yearly flood, Nut stretched across the sky while her brother Geb formed the earth beneath her, and Osiris ruled over the underworld and the growth of grain. Other gods, like Isis, Thoth, and Sekhmet, were connected to magic, wisdom, and disease, showing just how deeply religion touched nearly every part of Egyptian daily life, from farming to health to death itself.

At the very center of this religious worldview stood the pharaoh himself. Egyptians didn't see their king as simply a powerful ruler — they believed he was the living embodiment of the god Horus, and the son of Ra, meaning a god was believed to walk among them in human form. This idea shaped nearly everything about how Egyptian society was organized, since obeying pharaoh wasn't just a political duty, but a religious one. Understanding this belief matters enormously for what comes next in Egyptian history, since it sets the stage for one of the most dramatic religious confrontations in the ancient world.

Egyptians were also remarkably skilled astronomers, and their religious beliefs and star-watching were deeply intertwined. They carefully aligned the shafts inside their pyramids with specific stars, believing these alignments would help a pharaoh's spirit journey into the afterlife. The three stars of Orion's Belt, for example, were closely associated with Osiris, and some Egyptologists believe the three pyramids at Giza may reflect that same alignment. Ancient Egyptians also identified Thuban as their North Star around 2500 BC, using it much the way sailors and travelers still use the North Star today, to find true north and navigate confidently, even across the open desert at night.

This careful sky-watching wasn't just religious symbolism — it also led to one of Egypt's most practical and lasting achievements: a 365-day solar calendar. By tracking the yearly rising of a particular star alongside the Nile's flooding pattern, Egyptian astronomers created a calendar system reliable enough to predict the seasons, one that would eventually influence the calendar systems still used around the world today. It's a powerful reminder that ancient religious devotion and careful scientific observation weren't separate pursuits for the Egyptians — they were deeply connected, each one reinforcing the other.

This week, students will create their own Egyptian-style artwork on real papyrus. **Please bring water colors or markers to class if you want your artwork to be in color!**

You have no doubt noticed by now that Egyptians did not know about the one true God. However, God had a plan to use Egypt several times in His plan to save the world. During Session III, we will explore in-depth the story of the Exodus - particularly the plagues and how God shows his ultimate power over all of Egypt's false gods.

To wrap up Session I, I want you all to be Bible detectives. Here is your assignment this week:

What Bible Stories Include Egypt?

Go through the Bible and find every story that includes Egypt. Make a timeline list. Include the Old Testament and the New Testament.

Choose one story and draw a picture of one moment in that story, or write a few paragraphs to a few pages about that story as if you were one of the people experiencing it. Bring these artifacts to class to share.

Extension Activities for Mummification and Medicine

- Read the following pages in [The Usborne Internet Linked Encyclopedia of Ancient Egypt](#) to reinforce concepts from this week: pages 60-65..
- Solve nine clues and reveal a mummy in this online quiz game offered from the Birmingham Museums and Art Gallery in the UK.
<https://bmag-for-kids.birminghammuseums.org.uk/mummy.html>
- To compare and contrast our hope for the afterlife as Christians, read Matthew 28 (the whole chapter); Luke 24 (the whole chapter); 1 Corinthians 15:54-57; Revelation 21:1-5; John 14:1-7; and 2 Corinthians 5 (the whole chapter). Or find other Bible verses and stories that talk about Jesus defeating death.
- If you're interested in a podcast overview of Ancient Egypt, try listening to [Real Cool History for Kids Egyptian Pharaohs and Their Piles of Rocks](#). Thanks to Kassandra for telling me about this!
- Also this podcast: [Real Cool History for Kids The Story of King Tutankhamen](#). Again, thanks Kassandra! 😊